UNIT 2: KNOW YOURSELF

TOPIC 1: POSITIVE IDENTITY

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Discover that there are various facets to one's "identity"
- Understand that everyone has positive assets to their individual selves
- Understand the importance of identifying and using these assets in a career search

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Have their results from a vocational personality assessment, which they can use to narrow down career clusters/areas of interest
- Have a personal account at the Mass Career Information System **(Mass CIS)** career website

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will be able to understand the concepts of identity.
Time: 20 minutes
Materials: Handout: **"Identity Discussion Questions"** for everyone in the class

Use **"Identity Discussion Questions"** to discuss and connect self-knowledge and vocation.

Individual Work

Objective: Students will begin to identify their positive assets.
Time: 10 minutes
Materials: Handout: **"Your Best Personal Qualities"** check-list, pens/pencils

Ask everyone in the group to think of one thing they do well (help friends, play sports, fix cars, watch siblings, etc.). Then, ask them to think about what personal qualities helped them succeed at that task (such as patience, being a good listener, being a team player, etc.) Explain that within a job search, it is important to acknowledge and share your unique qualities with potential employers. Ask students to complete the **"Your Best Personal Qualities"** activity.

Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will understand how Vocational Personality Types (R,I,A,S,E,C) can be a key towards focusing on a career.
Time: 20 minutes
Materials: Handout: **"Vocational Personality Assessments,"** pens/pencils

Explain to the class that their unique qualities and traits can help steer them towards a career path.

Have the students take the **"Vocational Personality Types Assessment."** Afterwards, ask if the students agree with their individual assessments, and if comfortable, to share why or why not.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will become aware of technological resources that will help them in many areas — career choice, job search, education/training pathways, and life skills, etc.

Time: 10 minutes

Materials: Computers with internet connection, note cards for writing down names and passwords, pens/pencils

Introduce the **Mass CIS (masscis.intocareers.org)** as a valuable tool for job, career, and education searches. Youth can access the **Mass CIS** from anywhere with an internet connection. Have students log on and get a user name and password. From there, they can log into **"my portfolio,"** where they will be creating resumes and other documents in the future. Have each student write their information down in two places, one for the classroom, and one "to go" for their wallet.

Also, use this time to discuss with students where they might access a computer away from the classroom. Ask students to try and think of places they have computer access, and supplement with any resources known in the area (public libraries, one-stop career centers, youth centers, etc.).

Explain that the following exercises will help youth focus on accomplishments and traits they may not have thought of before, in order to see where they have some strengths and some interests. Then a specific vocational assessment (Holland's Vocational Personality) will follow.

Identity Discussion Questions

What is Identity? (Definition: the condition of being oneself or itself, and not another)

What things make up your identity? (age, gender, race, history, interests, friends, family, etc.)

Is your Identity always the same, or does it change?

Do you need to switch up your Identity at home? In class? On the job?

What are some ways to focus on or emphasize positive aspects of your identity?
(Hand out Personal Qualities Check-List)

How can knowing positive aspects of your personality help you in life?

How could personality and positive identity traits help you in a job/career search?

How can personality and positive identity traits help you once you have a job?

Your Best Personal Qualities (parts 1 and 2)

EFF Skill:	Learn, Speak	
EFF Task:	21US Monitor quality of own work, 36R Demonstrate willingness to work	Worksheet 9: 20-30 minutes

Your Best Personal Qualities

Personal qualities **are parts of our personality that make us who we are. Over a lifetime, we develop personal qualities that are unique to us. In job hunting and on the job it is important to know your strengths. Listen as the list of personal qualities is read. Put a check next to your "best" qualities.**

Personal Qualities	
☐ Adaptable, willing to make changes	☐ Motivated
☐ Calm	☐ Neat and orderly
☐ Careful	☐ Not afraid to ask questions
☐ Cheerful	☐ Patient
☐ Cooperative	☐ Pay good attention to details
☐ Dependable	☐ Pay attention to keeping costs down
☐ Friendly	☐ Persistent-keep at a job until it is done
☐ Energetic, self-starter	☐ Physically strong
☐ Flexible	☐ Punctual—always on time
☐ Good at following instructions	☐ Responsible
☐ Good at getting things done	☐ Risk taker
☐ Good at working on a team	☐ Take pride in my work
☐ Good imagination-creative	☐ Sensitive to the feelings of others
☐ Good sense of humor	☐ Well organized
☐ Hard worker	☐ Take initiative-able to solve problems on my own
☐ Helpful	☐ Work quickly and efficiently
☐ Honest	☐ Take pride in my work
☐ Like to learn new things	☐ Work well under pressure
☐ Loyal	

Special thanks to Gadsden County Adult and Community Education curriculum for the idea for this activity.

Adapted from www.floridaworks.org — National Work Readiness Mini-Course

EFF Skills:	Learn, Speak
EFF Task:	21US Monitor quality of own work, 6AUI Communicate in spoken English

Worksheet 10: 15 minutes

Describing Your Best Personal Qualities

orking on your own, list four of your best qualities. Then think about at least ıe example of how you have demonstrated this quality. For example, for ıependable" you might say, "I always show up to work on time or call if I will be late." Share what you wrote with your team.

Personal Quality	How I Have Shown That I Have this Quality
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	

Vocational Personality Assessments

Directions: *Circle the numbers of statements that clearly sound like something you might say, do, or think — something that feels like you. Place a check mark beside items that you aren't sure of to see how they change your score.*

1. It's important for me to have a strong body.
2. I need to understand things completely.
3. Music, color, beauty of any kind can really affect my mood.
4. People enrich my life and give it meaning.
5. I have confidence in myself that I can make things happen.
6. I need clear directions so I can do things right.
7. I can usually carry, build, and fix things myself.
8. I can get absorbed for hours thinking something out.
9. I appreciate beautiful surroundings; color and design mean a lot to me.
10. I'll spend time finding ways to help people through personal crises and problems.
11. I enjoy competing.
12. I'll spend time getting carefully organized before I start a project.
13. I enjoy making things with my hands.
14. It's satisfying to explore new ideas.
15. I always seem to be looking for new ways to be creative.
16. I value being able to share personal concerns with people.
17. Being a key person in a group is very satisfying to me.
18. I take pride in being very careful about all the details of my work.
19. I don't mind getting my hands dirty.
20. I see education as a lifelong process of developing and sharpening my mind.
21. I love to dress in unusual ways — to try new colors and styles.
22. I can often sense when a person needs to talk to someone.
23. I enjoy getting people organized and on the move.
24. I'd rather be safe than adventurous in making decisions.
25. I like to buy sensible things that I can make or work on myself.
26. Sometimes I can sit for long periods of time and work on puzzles or read or just think about life.
27. I have a great imagination.
28. I like to help people develop their talents and abilities.

29. I like to have people rely on me to get the job done.
30. I usually prepare carefully ahead of time if I have to handle a new situation.
31. I'd rather be on my own doing practical, hands-on activities.
32. I'm eager to read about any subject that arouses my curiosity.
33. I love to try creative new ideas.
34. If I have a problem with someone, I'll keep trying to resolve it peacefully.
35. To be successful, it's important to aim high.
36. I don't like to be responsible for big decisions.
37. I say what's on my mind and don't beat around the bush.
38. I need to analyze a problem pretty thoroughly before I act on it.
39. I like to rearrange my surroundings to make them unique and different.
40. I often solve my personal problems by talking them out with someone.
41. I get projects started and let others take care of the details.
42. Being on time is very important to me.
43. I love doing things outdoors.
44. I keep asking "Why?"
45. I like my work to be an expression of my moods and feelings.
46. I like to find ways to care more for each other.
47. It's exciting to take part in important decisions.
48. I usually have the things around me in order.
49. I like my surroundings to be plain and practical.
50. I need to stay with a problem until I figure out an answer.
51. The beauty of nature touches something deep inside me.
52. Close personal relationships are important to me.
53. Promotion and advancement are important to me.
54. I feel more secure when my day is well planned.
55. A strong system of law is important to prevent chaos.
56. Thought provoking books always broaden my perspective.
57. I like artwork, plays, and good movies.
58. I can deal with and understand people who express strong feeling.
59. It's exciting to influence people.

60. When I say I'll do it, I follow through on every detail.
61. Good, hard physical work never hurt anyone.
62. I'd like to learn all there is to know about subjects that interest me.
63. I don't want to be like everyone else; I like to do things differently.
64. When people have a problem, I go out of my way to be flexible and caring.
65. I'm willing to take some risks to get ahead.
66. I feel more secure when I follow rules.
67. The first thing I look for in a car is a well-built engine.
68. I like a conversation to be intellectually stimulating.
69. When I'm creating, I tend to let everything else go.
70. I feel concerned that so many people in our society need help.
71. It's fun to get ideas across to people.
72. I'm very good about checking details.
73. I usually know how to take care of things in an emergency.
74. Just reading about those new discoveries is exciting.
75. I like to create happenings.
76. I often go out of my way to pay attention to people who seem lonely and friendless.
77. I love to bargain.
78. I like to be very careful about spending money.
79. Sports are important in building strong bodies.
80. I've always been curious about the way nature works.
81. It's fun to be in a mood to try or do something unusual.
82. I am a good listener when people talk about personal problems.
83. If I don't make it the first time, I usually bounce back with energy and enthusiasm.
84. I need to know exactly what people expect of me.
85. I like to take things apart to see if I can fix them.
86. Don't get excited. We can think it out and plan the right move logically.
87. It would be hard to imagine my life without beauty around me.
88. People often seem to tell me their problems.
89. I can usually connect with people who get me in touch with a network of resources.
90. It's very satisfying to do a task carefully and completely.

Scoring Your Answers: *To score, circle the numbers that you circled on the interest inventory.*

R	I	A	S	E	C
1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36
37	38	39	40	41	42
43	44	45	46	47	48
49	50	51	52	53	54
55	56	57	58	59	60
61	62	63	64	65	66
67	68	69	70	71	72
73	74	75	76	77	78
79	80	81	82	83	84
85	86	87	88	89	90
R	I	A	S	E	C
total	**total**	**total**	**total**	**total**	**total**

List the letters R,I,A,S,E,C, according to your scores, from highest to lowest:

1st_____ 2nd_____ 3rd_____ 4th_____ 5th_____ 6th_____

Holland's Career Typology Background

John Holland's theory is grounded in what he calls modal personal orientation or a developmental process established through heredity and the individual's life history of reacting to environmental demands. More simply put, individuals are attracted to a particular occupation that meets their personal needs and provides them satisfaction.

Holland's theory rests on four assumptions:

1. In our culture, persons can be categorized as one of the following: Realistic, Investigative, Artistic, Social, Enterprising or Conventional.
2. There are six modal environments: realistic, investigative, artistic, social, enterprising and conventional.
3. People search for environments that will let them exercise their skills and abilities, express their attitudes and values, and take on agreeable problems and roles.
4. Behavior is determined by an interaction between personality and environment.

Much research supports Holland's typology. The strongest criticism is based on gender bias because females tend to score in three personality types (artistic, social and conventional). Holland attributes this to our society that channels females into female-dominated occupations.

Adapted from http://extension.psu.edu/workforce/briefs/overviewcareerdev(insert).pdf retrieved April 29, 2010

Vocational Personality Types

Realistic: "R"

"R" people are independent, practical, and physically strong. They use their hands/eyes to explore things and achieve. They require physical coordination, strength, agility, and logic. They enjoy risk, excitement, being outdoors, solving specific problems and using tools and machinery. They like to solve problems by doing.

"R" People:

Like mechanical activities
Like activities that let them see the result of their work
Like work that involves using machines, tools, and equipment
Like to develop manual, mechanical, agricultural, or electrical skills
Prefer occupations that might involve building or repairing things
Tend to be down-to-earth and matter-of-fact
Like to work out-of-doors
May prefer to work with things or objects more than people

Investigative: "I"

"I" people are independent, curious, intellectual, introspective, often unconventional. They enjoy challenge, variety, and complicated, abstract problems. They solve problems by thinking, using written information and instruments to solve problems. I people like mathematical or scientific activities.

"I" People:

Think through a problem before acting on it
Tend to be curious, studious, and independent
Like mathematical or scientific activities
Like activities that involve learning about a new subject area
Like to use their knowledge to find their own solutions to problems
Get so involved in an activity that they lose track of time
Search through many possible solutions for a problem
Like to solve complex problems

Artistic: "A"

"A" people are creative, independent, sensitive, and expressive. They use their hand/eyes/mind to create new things, writings, or ways of doing things. They enjoy beauty, unstructured activity, variety, interesting and unusual sights, sounds, textures, and people. They solve problems by creating.

"A" people:

Prefer to make their own plans for a project rather than being given plans
Like activities that allow them to be creative
Like to be independent
Like activities that allow them to use their imagination to do original work
Like activities that let them work according to their own rules
Like to express himself or herself through drama, art, music, or writing
Like to feel free from scheduled routine so that time can be used for creative activities
Like privacy when they are creating

Social: "S"

"S" people are people lovers. They are concerned, sensitive, and supportive. They enjoy activities that allow them to use their skills and talents to interact effectively with others. They are generally less interested in performing mechanical activities or tasks. They like activities that involve working with and helping others. They enjoy closeness, sharing, groups, unstructured activity and being in charge. They enjoy teaching, developing, or helping others.

"S" people:

Tend to be friendly and helpful
Like activities that involve working with others rather than alone
Like activities that involve informing, training, teaching, understanding, and helping others
Think most people are easy to get along with
Usually feel good about expressing themselves verbally
Meet new people and make friends easily
Like helping people solve their problems
Like being asked to take a leadership role

Enterprising: "E"

"E" people are energetic, independent, enthusiastic, confident, and often dominant. They're good with words and enjoy organizing, persuading, leading, managing, excitement variety, and status. Economic goals are important. They like activities where they can take a leadership role or speak in front of groups. They may be less interested in performing scientific tasks. They like fast-paced activities and ones that require taking on a lot of responsibility. They often solve problems by taking risks.

"E" people:

Have little problem explaining their ideas
Like being in charge of activities
Like speaking in front of groups
Like activities that are fast-paced
Like activities that require them to take on responsibility
Like activities that permit leading or influencing others
Like activities involving sales or management of people and things
Like to try something that hasn't been done before

Conventional: "C"

"C" people feel most comfortable doing structured tasks. They like activities that require attention to detail and accuracy. They enjoy order, certainty, and security. They may be less interested in artistic tasks. They're efficient, practical and orderly in the way they go about things. They are generally reasonable, reliable, and calm.

"C" People:

Like to know exactly what is expected of them in a new situation
Tend to be responsible and dependable
Usually keep their cool and don't lose their temper in times of stress
Like activities that allow them to use their organizational skills
Like activities that require attention to detail
Like activities that require attention to accuracy
Like activities involving preparing records, filing papers, typing letters and/or operating computers

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003